

Dedicated to Miss J.F. Cook
The Better Land

Felicia Hemans

Frederic Hymen Cowen

Non troppo allegro

Voice

Piano *p* *Tranquillo*

4

p

I hear thee speak _____ of the

7

Bet - ter Land, _____ Thou call'st its chil - - dren a hap - py band, _____

cresc.

Mo-ther, where _____ is that ra - diant shore? Shall we not seek it,

cresc.

Shall we not seek it, and weep no more? _____ Is it

cresc.

where the flow'r _____ of the or - ange blows, And the fire - flies dance _____ thro' the

cresc.

Lento p

myr - tle boughs? _____ Not there, not there, my

Lento

dim. e rall.

25 **Tempo I**

child.

p *Tranquillo*

mf

Is it far a - way, _____ in some re - gion old, _____ Where the

p

cresc.

ri - vers wan - - der o'er sands of gold, Where the burn - ing rays _____ of the

cresc.

cresc.

ru - by shine, _____ And the dia-mond lights up, the dia-mond lights up _____ the

cresc. ed agitato

se - - - cret mine, _____ And the pearl gleams forth _____ from the

cresc.

4

41

co - ral strand Is it there, sweet mo - - ther, that Bet - ter Land? Is it

mf

44

there, sweet mo - ther, that Bet - - ter Land? _____

mf *dim. e rall.*

Red.

48

Lento *p* Not there, not there, my

Lento *p*

✿

53 **Tempo I**

child.

pp Tranquillo *rall.*

Molto andante57 *p* *Tranquillamente*

Eye hath not seen it, my gen - tle boy, Ear hath not heard its deep

Molto andante
p *pesante*

60

cresc.

songs of joy; Dreams can - not pic - ture a world so fair.

cresc.

63

Sor - row and death, sor - row and death may not en - ter there;

67

sempre crescendo

Time doth not breathe on its fade - less bloom, on its fade - less bloom,

sempre crescendo

6

71 *ff* *p* *ff*

Far be - yond, _____ be-yond the clouds, Far be -

sf *dim.* *sf*

75 *p* *cresc.*

-yond, _____ be-yond the tomb, _____ Far be - yond the clouds, and be - yond the tomb, It is

dim. *cresc.*

79 *ff* *con tutta la forza*

there, it is there, my child! it is there, 'tis

ff *rit.*

83

there! _____

ff *rit.* 8^{va} *Red.*